Skills, employers and industry

Using Data to Drive Business Performance

Nimrod Dvir, PhD · Publisher discussion draft · October 2026

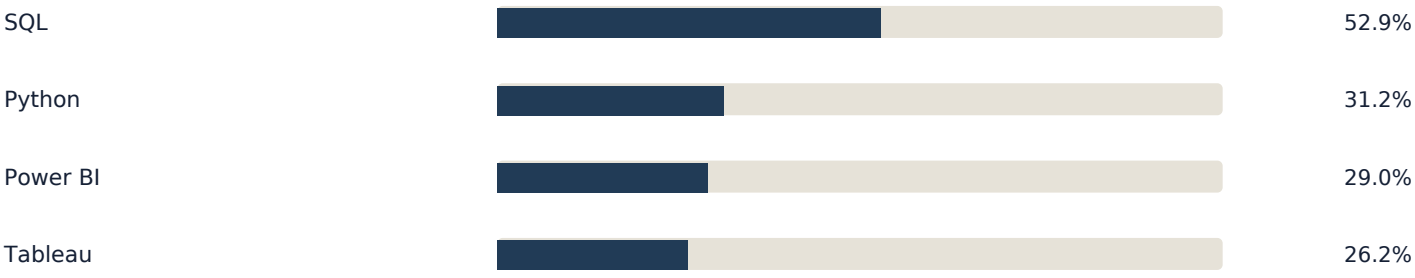
What we researched

A 2026 analysis by 365 Data Science of 1,000 Indeed USA data analyst postings (855 relevant), U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics projections for 2025-35, and the World Economic Forum employer survey.

What employers ask for

We looked at what employers ask for in the skills this book teaches.

52.9% of job postings	**U.S. data analyst job postings that ask for SQL** Of 855 relevant postings in a vendor analysis of 1,000 Indeed USA listings. Python appears in 31.2%, Power BI in 29.0% and Tableau in 26.2%.Source: 365 Data Science [9]
+35% growth, 2025 to 2035	**Projected growth in data scientist jobs** Against 3% for all occupations. Median pay: $120,230 a year (May 2025).Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics [10]
+9% growth, 2025 to 2035	**Projected growth in database architect jobs** Median pay: $139,500 a year (May 2025).Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics [11]
About two-thirds of employers worldwide	**Plan to hire for AI skills** AI and big data are the fastest-growing skills employers report.Source: World Economic Forum [12]



Share of 855 U.S. data analyst job postings that list each skill.

Evidence	Finding	Courseware implication
BLS: data scientists, 2025-35	**35% projected growth** , compared with 3% for all occupations; about **24,800 openings annually** . [L1]	Connect data preparation and queries to interpretation, communication, and decisions.
BLS: database architects / administrators, 2025-35	Architects: **9%** growth. Administrators: **0%** . Combined: about **7,300 openings annually** . [L2]	Retain modeling, quality, permissions, backup, and system judgment alongside analytics.
WEF: Future of Jobs Report 2025	Survey of **1,000+ employers** , representing **14 million+ workers** across **55 economies** ; roughly **7 in 10** identify analytical thinking as essential. [L3]	Require students to explain a result, test its reliability, and justify an action.
WEF: skills outlook to 2030	AI and big data lead the skills employers expect to grow fastest. [L3]	Integrate responsible AI use, verification, data provenance, and limits across the learning experience.

Main conclusion SQL, reporting and judgment belong together. Students need to produce a result, establish that it is reliable, and communicate what an organization should do with it.

Job-posting shares describe this sample of 855 postings, not all U.S. hiring. BLS growth projections (the change in employment, 2025-35) and annual openings are separate measures: openings include replacement hiring, so they can be substantial even where growth is flat. Global employer expectations (WEF) are distinct from U.S. job-posting requirements.

References

• 365 Data Science. (2026, April 28). The data analyst job market in 2026: Research on 1,000 job postings (Indeed USA; 855 relevant postings). Vendor analysis, not peer reviewed. Link

• U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. (2026). Occupational Outlook Handbook: Data scientists. Link

• U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. (2026). Occupational Outlook Handbook: Database administrators and architects. Link

• World Economic Forum. (2025). The Future of Jobs Report 2025. Link

[L1]

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Data Scientists ↗

Current Occupational Outlook Handbook read October 25, 2026. Projects 35% employment growth, 2025-2035; all occupations 3%.

[L2]

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Database Administrators and Architects ↗

Current Occupational Outlook Handbook read October 25, 2026. Architects 9%; administrators 0%; combined 4%, 2025-2035. Rounded percentages.

[L3]

World Economic Forum: Future of Jobs Report 2025 ↗

Employer expectations for 2025-2030: analytical thinking essential to about seven in ten responding companies; AI and big data lead skills expected to grow. Global employer survey, not U.S. hiring requirements.